

STAGE FIVE • THINKING, REASONING & MENTAL MODELS

FIRSTS

SESSION DEBRIEF / CLOSE-OUT SCRIPT

How to end each session, summarize, and bridge to what's next

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Session Debrief / Close-Out Script

Stage Five • Thinking, Reasoning & Mental Models

WHY THIS MATTERS

A genuine close-out does three things every time: names what was actually accomplished, connects it forward to what's next, and gives a specific, concrete action to take before the next session. This matters especially in Stage Five, where thirty distinct frameworks can start to blur together without a clear thread reinforcing which ones build on which.

Close-Out Scripts

SESSION 1

Closing Session 1

"Today you built eight foundational tools: naming mental models, mapping cause and effect, breaking down problems, structured decisions, root cause analysis, critical thinking, hypothesis testing, and scenario planning."

"The real test of today isn't whether you can define these tools — it's whether you reach for one the next time you're actually facing a decision. That's the shift we're going for."

"Before next time: think of one piece of real feedback you've received recently. We'll use it in Session 2."

SESSION 2

Closing Session 2

"Today turned the tools inward: catching your own biases, seeing systems instead of isolated failures, integrating real feedback, prioritizing deliberately, applying a model rigorously, spotting patterns, and reflecting honestly on your own decisions."

"That closes out the foundational category. Everything from here scales these same ideas up to bigger, more complex decisions."

"Before next time: identify one real, complex, multi-step decision you're facing. We'll use it across several exercises in Session 3."

SESSION 3

Closing Session 3

"That was a lot: SWOT thinking, first-principles analysis, inversion, opportunity cost, 80/20 analysis, systems thinking applied to a real team, decision trees, and scenario analysis."

"If your head feels full, that's genuinely appropriate — this was the densest session in the stage. Give yourself permission to only fully absorb two or three of these deeply rather than all eight equally."

"Before next time: identify one repeated task that could benefit from a checklist. That's where we start next session."

SESSION 4

Closing Session 4 (Stage Close)

"That's Stage Five, complete. Thirty FIRSTS across four sessions, from naming your first mental model to a strategic map connecting your daily actions to your longer-term goals."

"The honest truth about this stage is that most of these tools fade without deliberate use. The value isn't in having done this once — it's in actually reaching for one of these frameworks the next time a real decision comes up."

"Before we close: name one specific mental model or framework, out of all thirty, that you genuinely intend to keep using. Not the most recent one by default — the one that actually landed for you."

“Stage Six picks up with Communication — the clear thinking you've built here becomes the foundation for expressing it clearly to other people.”